Tungsten Supply Security

What the implementation evidence shows about selected tungsten supply-security measures.

Benjamin Yang | Strategic Materials Policy Tracker
Research cutoff 3 November 2026 | Version 1.0

One material.
Different policy tests.

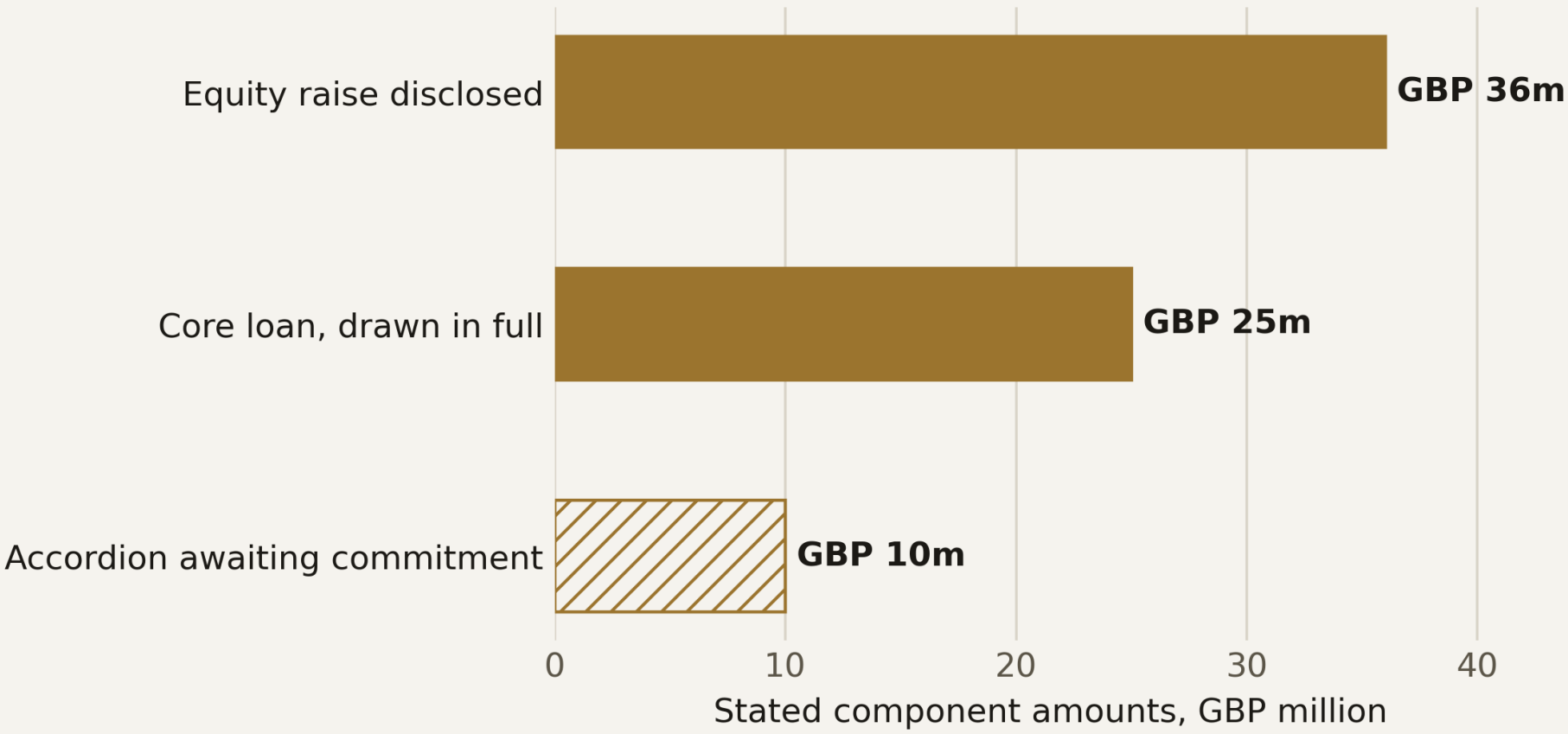
China regulates defined transactions. EU recognition supports project development. UK finance supports a restart. Japan’s selected grants support conversion expansion.

System	Instrument	What is established	What remains to test
China	Export licensing	Permission for defined goods and technology	Approvals, enforcement and item-aligned shipments
EU	Strategic Projects	Administrative recognition; development support	Financing closure, permit progress, construction and output
UK	Public equity / loan	Capital for Hemerdon restart; loan drawn	Expenditure, sustained output, delivery and additionality
Japan	Certification / grants	Awards supporting conversion expansion	Payments, equipment installation, commissioning and new output

Each instrument calls for a distinct implementation measure. Sources: S01, S08, S12, S14.

The £71m package combines equity and lending.

The headline contains GBP 36m equity, GBP 25m core lending and a GBP 10m accordion subject to separate commitment. The accounts explicitly disclose full core-loan drawdown.



Sources: S14, S20; S31 PDF pp. 39 and 67. Separate the unpriced government procurement negotiation.

Hemerdon reports processing and signs an Elmet offtake.

Hemerdon reports processing and a binding Elmet agreement. Earlier concentrate activity predates the NWF announcement; public support’s additionality remains unresolved.

When	Documented observation	Source
Before 25 August	Commissioning / concentrate activity reported	S20; S31
By 2 September	GBP 25m core loan fully drawn	S31
15 September	Ore processing / ramp-up report	S21
23 September	Elmet binding contract; deliveries unverified	S35; S36

Next verification: sustained output, realized deliveries and incremental production attributable to support. Sources: S20, S21, S31, S35, S36.

The same designation can cover different readiness.

El Moto reports construction, targeting Q1 2029 production. Its developer’s separately designated APT proposal awaits final investment approval.

Project	Physical position	Operating position
El Moto	Construction and ramp development reported	Q1 2029 first-production target
EU APT Tungsten Plant	Evaluation / technical-partner discussions	Production requires investment approval established

Sources: S04, S05, S08, S09, S24, S25. Designation and plant operation are separate project milestones.

Japanese awards support future conversion capacity.

JOGMEC now lists both selected grants. The recipient plans concern powder / carbide capacity and scrap-to-APT conversion, with 2028–29 operating targets.

Recipient	Grant award	Total plan	Capacity target	Operating target
Allied Material	~JPY 7.5bn	~JPY 15.9bn	~1.5x powder / carbide capacity	First half FY2028
Japan New Metals	~JPY 2bn	~JPY 8bn	2,400 tonnes/year WO3-equivalent APT capacity	April 2029

Next verification: grant payments, commissioning and production from supported expansions. Sources: S12, S13, S17.

The database is a starting point for investigation.

SMPT links measures, instruments, projects and sources. Supplemental checks reveal the UK loan drawdown and a more advanced Japanese award status.

Starting point	Research path	Result
China licensing / EU recognition	Event → control or designation → source item / annex	Legal obligations call for distinct implementation measures
Hemerdon financing	Event → package / parts → project → issuer terms / accounts	Avoid package duplication; identify the core loan actually drawn
Japan New Metals	Certification → grant / project → current JOGMEC / MMC release	Award status has advanced; Akita expansion remains future capacity

Four-system selection: 11 events, 8 projects, 8 designations, 6 raw finance rows and 2 controls. Selective coverage; counts overlap.

Ask for the next missing piece of evidence.

For Hemerdon: sustained output and deliveries. For Japan’s expansions: payment and commissioning. For the APT proposal: investment approval. For licensing: item-aligned transaction evidence.